VENVLEARNING

TEACHER EDITION



Social Studies

GRADE 7

Guided lessons, pacing, and complete answer keys

2 units

VENVLEARNING

Grade 7 Social Studies

TEACHER EDITION

Unit 1 Early Humans and Mesopotamia

Unit 2 River Valley Civilizations

A VenvLearning family homeschool curriculum

How to use this Teacher Edition

This book holds everything needed to teach the course: unit overviews, a plan for every lesson with what to say and do, the student lesson with Try It answers, and answer keys for every workbook page, weekly check and unit test.

- Daily routine (about 45–55 minutes): Warm-Up 5 · Read and Discuss 15 · Analyze 10 · Guided Practice 7 · Independent 10 · Exit Ticket 3.
- Say: lines are a suggested script. Use your own words.
- Two lessons a week, then the Weekly Check (about 15 minutes), then corrections or a project.
- Each plan's Pacing row and each unit's pacing guide give the week and lesson order. Set the days to fit your own calendar.

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UNIT 1 · TEACHER OVERVIEW

Early Humans and Mesopotamia

Historians' tools, early humans, the Agricultural Revolution, the first cities, Sumer, writing, and the first empires and laws.

Ten thousand years ago, nearly everyone on Earth lived by hunting and gathering. Then, in a few river valleys, people began to farm, settle, and build cities. In this unit you'll learn how historians uncover the distant past, then follow humans from the Old Stone Age to Sumer, where people built the first cities, invented writing, and carved laws in stone.

Big ideas

- Use primary and secondary sources and read BCE/CE timelines.
- Explain how the Agricultural Revolution changed human life.
- Analyze how Mesopotamia's geography shaped civilization.
- Describe Sumerian society, writing, and the first empires and laws.

Standards

Code	Standard
C3 D2.His.1, 2, 9, 10	Historical context; change and continuity; sources and their limitations.
C3 D2.Geo.2, 4	Maps; human–environment interaction.
C3 D2.Civ.3	Origins and purposes of laws.

What students should already know

- Basic map skills.
- Timelines.

Materials for the unit

- Box of everyday objects
- Pan, soil, water

- Clay or play dough
- Dried beans
- World map or atlas

Pacing guide

Teach the lessons in order, then give the week's check. Set the days to fit your own calendar.

Week	Order	Lesson	Title
Week 1	Lesson 1 of 2	1.1	How Historians Know the Past
Week 1	Lesson 2 of 2	1.2	Early Humans: Hunter-Gatherers
Week 1	End of week	Check	Weekly Check 1: Historians and Early Humans
Week 2	Lesson 1 of 2	1.3	The Agricultural Revolution
Week 2	Lesson 2 of 2	1.4	From Villages to Civilizations
Week 2	End of week	Check	Weekly Check 2: Farming and Civilization
Week 3	Lesson 1 of 2	1.5	Mesopotamia: The Land Between the Rivers
Week 3	Lesson 2 of 2	1.6	Sumer: City-States, Ziggurats, and Society
Week 3	End of week	Check	Weekly Check 3: Mesopotamia and Sumer
Week 4	Lesson 1 of 2	1.7	Cuneiform and the Invention of Writing
Week 4	Lesson 2 of 2	1.8	Empires and the Code of Hammurabi
Week 4	Before the test	Review	Unit 1 Review
Week 4	End of unit	Test	Unit 1 Test

TEACHING THIS UNIT AT HOME

Look at a clock and a compass together and talk about how the Sumerian base-60 system still shapes how we measure time and angles.

UNIT VOCABULARY

primary source	Created at the time by a participant.
Agricultural Revolution	The shift to farming.
civilization	A complex society with cities and government.
irrigation	Bringing water to crops.
cuneiform	Sumerian wedge-shaped writing.
empire	Many lands under one ruler.

LESSON 1.1 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 1 · Lesson 1 of 2
Unit 1: Early Humans and Mesopotamia

Lesson 1.1: How Historians Know the Past

Student goal	I can distinguish primary and secondary sources, explain how archaeologists learn about the past, and read a BCE/CE timeline.
Objective	Students classify sources and read BCE/CE timelines.
Standard	C3 D2.His.9.6-8, D2.His.10.6-8 — Classify sources; detect limitations of the historical record.
Pacing	Unit 1, week 1, lesson 1 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Box of everyday objects, workbook Lesson 1.1
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Bedroom in 5,000 years.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson.
Analyze	10	Model source questions. Model counting across BCE/CE.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook lesson pages: Warm-Up through Exit Ticket.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Treating BCE dates like CE (thinking larger numbers are later).

SUPPORT

- Number line with BCE to the left.

EXTEND

- Interview a grandparent: an oral history is a primary source.

STUDENT LESSON 1.1 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.1: How Historians Know the Past

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 1.1, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 1.1 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity, Time Capsule Detectives, on your Activity Sheet (Workbook Lesson 1.1, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.1, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 1.1: Parts D–E.

THINK ABOUT IT

Imagine someone in 5,000 years digs up your bedroom. What would your things tell them about you, and what would they get wrong?

Historians are detectives. They gather evidence from primary sources (letters, laws, inscriptions, photographs, artifacts) and secondary sources (textbooks, articles, documentaries). For times before writing, archaeologists study artifacts, bones, seeds, and buildings. Scientists can estimate the age of once-living material using radiocarbon dating.

Every source has limits. A king's inscription may brag. Artifacts made of stone and clay survive, but cloth, wood, and memories usually don't. Good historians ask: Who made this? When? Why? What might be missing?

Dates before year 1 are written BCE and count down toward year 1: 3000 BCE is earlier than 2000 BCE. Dates after are CE and count up. There is no year 0.



LOOK CLOSER · COUNT ACROSS THE BCE/CE LINE

How many years passed between 500 BCE and 500 CE?

1 From 500 BCE to 1 BCE is 499 years; then 1 BCE to 1 CE is 1 year.

2 From 1 CE to 500 CE is 499 years.

3 499 + 1 + 499 = 999.

Answer: 999 years (because there is no year 0).

ACTIVITY · TIME CAPSULE DETECTIVES

What can objects tell us, and what can't they?

You need: a box of 6–8 everyday objects chosen by your teacher (receipt, toy, coin, photo, tool, food wrapper).

1 Examine each object as if you were an archaeologist in the year 7026.

2 For each, write one inference about the people who used it.

3 Sort the objects into primary sources and secondary sources (if any).

4 Write what these objects can't tell you about the family.

Record: an evidence chart: Object | What it suggests | Questions it raises.

★ KEY IDEA

Historians use primary and secondary sources, ask who made a source and why, and recognize that evidence is always incomplete.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Primary or secondary: a clay tablet written in 2000 BCE

Answer: primary

2. Primary or secondary: a website about ancient Sumer

Answer: secondary

3. Which is earlier, 2500 BCE or 1800 BCE?

Answer: 2500 BCE

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.1

#	Question	Answer
1	An object made by people long ago	artifact
2	A source made by an eyewitness	primary source
3	Record your results in the table. (figure)	Answers vary. Check that every part is filled in and matches what the student did.
4	Primary or secondary: a clay tablet written in 2000 BCE	primary
5	Primary or secondary: a website about ancient Sumer	secondary

#	Question	Answer
6	Which is earlier, 2500 BCE or 1800 BCE?	2500 BCE
7	Primary or secondary: a diary from 1863	primary
8	Primary or secondary: your history textbook	secondary
9	Primary or secondary: a stone tool	primary (artifact)
10	Order from earliest: 1200 BCE, 3500 BCE, 200 CE, 500 BCE	3500 BCE, 1200 BCE, 500 BCE, 200 CE
11	Years from 3000 BCE to 1000 BCE	2,000 years
12	Years from 200 BCE to 300 CE	499 years
13	A king's victory monument says he never lost a battle. Why should a historian be careful with this source?	It was made to praise the king, so it may exaggerate or leave out defeats.
14	Name one strength and one limit of using artifacts as evidence.	Strength: real objects from the time. Limit: only durable items survive; they don't explain thoughts or events.

LESSON 1.2 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 1 · Lesson 2 of 2
Unit 1: Early Humans and Mesopotamia

Lesson 1.2: Early Humans: Hunter-Gatherers

Student goal	I can describe how early humans lived as hunter-gatherers and spread across the world.
Objective	Students describe Paleolithic life and migration.
Standard	C3 D2.His.1.6-8, D2.Geo.6.6-8 — Analyze connections among events; explain how humans spread.
Pacing	Unit 1, week 1, lesson 2 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Workbook Lesson 1.2
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	No stores or farms.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson.
Analyze	10	Discuss needs chart; evidence for early life.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook. The Weekly Check comes next.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Picturing “cavemen” as unintelligent.

SUPPORT

- Picture walk of artifacts.

EXTEND

- Research the Lascaux cave paintings.

STUDENT LESSON 1.2 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.2: Early Humans: Hunter-Gatherers

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 1.2, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 1.2 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity, What's in the Pack?, on your Activity Sheet (Workbook Lesson 1.2, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.2, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 1.2: Parts D–E.

THINK ABOUT IT

If you had no stores, farms, or metal tools, how would you get food and stay warm?

Fossils show that our species, Homo sapiens, appeared in Africa roughly 300,000 years ago. Over many thousands of years, groups migrated out of Africa into Asia, Europe, Australia, and eventually the Americas.

For almost all of human history, people lived as hunter-gatherers during the Paleolithic, or Old Stone Age. Small groups of related families moved with the seasons, following herds and ripening plants. They made tools of stone, bone, and wood, used fire to cook and stay warm, made clothing from hides, and painted animals on cave walls, such as the famous paintings at Lascaux, France, made about 17,000 years ago.

Need	How hunter-gatherers met it
food	hunting, fishing, gathering nuts, roots, berries
shelter	caves, huts of branches, bones, and hides
tools	stone blades and scrapers, spears, needles of bone
communication and art	spoken language, cave paintings, carvings, music

ACTIVITY · WHAT'S IN THE PACK?

What would a nomadic family carry?

You need: paper; pencil.

1 Your band of 25 is moving to its winter camp. Everything must be carried.

2 List the 8 most important items you would take and why.

3 Compare your list with a family member's and agree on a final list.

Record: your final list with a reason for each item.

★ KEY IDEA

For most of human history, people were nomadic hunter-gatherers who used stone tools and fire and spread from Africa across the world.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Where did Homo sapiens first appear?

Answer: Africa

2. Why did hunter-gatherers move often?

Answer: to follow herds and seasonal plants

3. Name one Paleolithic technology.

Answer: stone tools, fire, bone needles, spears

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.2

#	Question	Answer
1	Old Stone Age	Paleolithic
2	A person who moves from place to place	nomad
3	Record your band's final list of 8 items. (figure)	Answers vary. Check that every part is filled in and matches what the student did.
4	Where did Homo sapiens first appear?	Africa
5	Why did hunter-gatherers move often?	to follow herds and seasonal plants
6	Name one Paleolithic technology.	stone tools, fire, bone needles, spears
7	Why did groups stay small?	An area could only feed a small group; easier to move.
8	What do cave paintings suggest about early people?	They had art, beliefs, and close knowledge of animals.
9	How did fire change life?	warmth, cooking, protection, light
10	Explain why archaeologists know more about Paleolithic tools than Paleolithic clothing.	Stone tools survive for thousands of years; hides and plant fibers usually rot away.

#	Question	Answer
11	Describe one advantage and one challenge of the hunter-gatherer way of life.	Advantage: varied diet, freedom to move. Challenge: food could be scarce; constant travel.

WEEKLY CHECK · ANSWER KEY
After Lesson 1.2

About 15 minutes

Weekly Check 1: Historians and Early Humans — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Primary or secondary: a photo taken in 1920	primary
2	Primary or secondary: an encyclopedia article	secondary
3	Which is earlier: 1500 BCE or 900 BCE?	1500 BCE
4	Years between 300 BCE and 200 CE	499
5	Where did Homo sapiens first appear?	Africa
6	Why did hunter-gatherers move from place to place?	to follow animals and seasonal plants for food

LESSON 1.3 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 2 · Lesson 1 of 2
Unit 1: Early Humans and Mesopotamia

Lesson 1.3: The Agricultural Revolution

Student goal	I can explain how farming began and how it changed human life.
Objective	Students analyze the Agricultural Revolution.
Standard	C3 D2.His.2.6-8, D2.Geo.4.6-8 — Analyze change and continuity; human–environment interaction.
Pacing	Unit 1, week 2, lesson 1 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Workbook Lesson 1.3
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Move or stay?
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson; study the map.
Analyze	10	Discuss before/after chart; costs of farming.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook lesson pages: Warm-Up through Exit Ticket.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Thinking farming happened suddenly everywhere.

SUPPORT

- Before/after picture cards.

EXTEND

- Sprout wheat or barley seeds in a cup.

STUDENT LESSON 1.3 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.3: The Agricultural Revolution

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 1.3, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 1.3 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity, Gains and Losses, on your Activity Sheet (Workbook Lesson 1.3, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.3, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 1.3: Parts D–E.

THINK ABOUT IT

Would you rather move every season to find food, or stay in one place and grow it? What would you gain and lose?

Beginning around 10,000 BCE in the Fertile Crescent of Southwest Asia, people began planting wild wheat and barley and herding goats and sheep. This change, called the Agricultural Revolution, took thousands of years. Farming also began on its own in other places: rice and millet in China, corn in Mexico, potatoes in South America.

Early farming villages in the Fertile Crescent



Before farming	After farming
nomadic	settled villages
small bands	larger populations
food found or hunted	food grown and stored; surplus
few possessions	houses, pottery, tools for farming
most people did the same work	some people specialized in other jobs

Farming brought problems too. People worked long hours, ate fewer kinds of food, and could starve if crops failed. Living close together and near animals spread disease. Still, food surplus allowed populations to grow and set the stage for cities.

ACTIVITY · GAINS AND LOSSES

Was farming an improvement?

You need: paper.

1 Make a T-chart: Gains | Losses.

2 List at least four of each from the lesson.

3 Decide: for an ordinary person, was life better or worse? Write a claim with two pieces of evidence.

Record: your T-chart and claim.

★ KEY IDEA

Domesticating plants and animals let people settle, grow surpluses, and build larger communities, with new benefits and new problems.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Where did farming first begin?

Answer: the Fertile Crescent (Southwest Asia)

2. What is a surplus?

Answer: more than is needed

3. Name one problem farming created.

Answer: e.g. disease, harder work, crop failure

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.3

#	Question	Answer
1	New Stone Age	Neolithic
2	Taming plants and animals	domestication
3	Make your T-chart. (figure)	Answers vary. Check that every part is filled in and matches what the student did.
4	Claim: for an ordinary person, was life better or worse? Give two pieces of evidence.	Answers vary. Check that every part is filled in and matches what the student did.
5	Where did farming first begin?	the Fertile Crescent (Southwest Asia)
6	What is a surplus?	more than is needed
7	Name one problem farming created.	e.g. disease, harder work, crop failure
8	Two crops first domesticated in the Fertile Crescent	wheat and barley
9	A crop first domesticated in Mexico	corn (maize)
10	Why did farming lead to settled villages?	Farmers had to stay near their fields.
11	How did surplus lead to new jobs?	Not everyone had to farm, so some could specialize.

#	Question	Answer
12	Write a claim: Was the Agricultural Revolution good for humans? Support it with two pieces of evidence.	Answers vary; must use evidence from both lists.
13	Why do historians call farming a “revolution” even though it took thousands of years?	It completely changed how humans lived.

LESSON 1.4 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 2 · Lesson 2 of 2
Unit 1: Early Humans and Mesopotamia

Lesson 1.4: From Villages to Civilizations

Student goal	I can identify the features of a civilization and explain how surplus led to cities.
Objective	Students identify the features of civilization.
Standard	C3 D2.His.1.6-8 — Analyze connections among events and developments.
Pacing	Unit 1, week 2, lesson 2 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Dried beans, role cards, workbook Lesson 1.4
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	City vs village.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson.
Analyze	10	Discuss features chart; flow chart.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook. The Weekly Check comes next.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Thinking “civilized” means “better.”

SUPPORT

- Features checklist.

EXTEND

- Research how Çatalhöyük was excavated.

STUDENT LESSON 1.4 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.4: From Villages to Civilizations

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 1.4, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 1.4 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity, Village to City Simulation, on your Activity Sheet (Workbook Lesson 1.4, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.4, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 1.4: Parts D–E.

THINK ABOUT IT

What makes a city different from a village?

Some farming villages grew into towns. Jericho, near the Jordan River, had a stone wall and tower by about 8000 BCE. Çatalhöyük in Anatolia (modern Turkey) was home to thousands of people around 7000 BCE; its houses were built so close together that people walked across the rooftops and entered through openings in the roofs.

Historians use several features to describe a civilization:

Feature	Why it appears
cities	food surplus supports many people in one place
organized government	leaders manage water, defense, and laws
specialized jobs	potters, weavers, priests, soldiers, traders
social classes	some people gain more wealth or power
religion and public buildings	temples unite people around shared beliefs
writing and record keeping	track harvests, taxes, and trade
technology and art	new tools, buildings, and crafts



ACTIVITY · VILLAGE TO CITY SIMULATION

How does a surplus change a community?

You need: 20 dried beans (grain); role cards: farmer, potter, priest, guard, trader.

1 Each farmer 'grows' 5 beans per season but needs only 3 to eat.

2 Decide how the 2 extra beans per farmer can support people with other jobs.

3 Add one more job each round as the surplus grows.

Record: how many non-farmers your surplus could support, and the new problems (who decides? who guards the beans?).

★ KEY IDEA

Food surplus led to larger populations, specialized jobs, and the features of civilization.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Name three features of a civilization.

Answer: e.g. cities, government, specialized jobs, social classes, writing

2. What made specialization possible?

Answer: food surplus

3. How did people enter houses at Çatalhöyük?

Answer: through openings in the roofs

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.4

#	Question	Answer
1	A complex society with cities and writing	civilization
2	Doing one kind of job	specialization
3	Record your results in the table. (figure)	Answers vary. Check that every part is filled in and matches what the student did.
4	How many non-farmers could your surplus support? What new problems came up?	Answers vary. Check that every part is filled in and matches what the student did.
5	Name three features of a civilization.	e.g. cities, government, specialized jobs, social classes, writing
6	What made specialization possible?	food surplus

#	Question	Answer
7	How did people enter houses at Çatalhöyük?	through openings in the roofs
8	Why might a growing town need a government?	to organize water, defense, and laws
9	Why did record keeping develop?	to track harvests, taxes, and trade
10	Put in order: cities, surplus, farming, specialization	farming, surplus, specialization, cities
11	Is your community a civilization by the historians' definition? Use three features as evidence.	Answers vary.
12	Explain the chain from farming to cities.	Farming → surplus → population growth → specialized jobs and trade → cities and government.

WEEKLY CHECK · ANSWER KEY
After Lesson 1.4

About 15 minutes

Weekly Check 2: Farming and Civilization — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Where did farming first begin?	the Fertile Crescent
2	What is a food surplus?	more food than needed
3	Name two features of a civilization.	e.g. cities, government, writing, specialized jobs
4	Name an early farming town.	Jericho or Çatalhöyük
5	Explain how a food surplus led to specialized jobs.	Not everyone had to farm, so some people could do other work.

LESSON 1.5 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 3 · Lesson 1 of 2
Unit 1: Early Humans and Mesopotamia

Lesson 1.5: Mesopotamia: The Land Between the Rivers

Student goal	I can explain how the geography of Mesopotamia shaped early civilization there.
Objective	Students analyze geography's effect on Mesopotamia.
Standard	C3 D2.Geo.2.6-8, D2.Geo.4.6-8 — Use maps; explain how environment influences cultural patterns.
Pacing	Unit 1, week 3, lesson 1 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Pan, soil, water, craft stick, workbook Lesson 1.5
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	First cities in a dry land.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson; study the map.
Analyze	10	Discuss challenge/solution chart.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook lesson pages: Warm-Up through Exit Ticket.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Thinking the floods were gentle and regular like the Nile's.

SUPPORT

- Challenge → solution cards.

EXTEND

- Compare with Mississippi Delta flooding and levees.

STUDENT LESSON 1.5 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.5: Mesopotamia: The Land Between the Rivers

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 1.5, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 1.5 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity, Irrigation Model, on your Activity Sheet (Workbook Lesson 1.5, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.5, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 1.5: Parts D–E.

THINK ABOUT IT

Mesopotamia had hot, dry summers and almost no rain in the south, yet it became home to the world's first cities. How?

The Fertile Crescent



Mesopotamia lies between the Tigris and Euphrates rivers in modern Iraq. Each spring, snow melting in the northern mountains made the rivers flood, spreading rich silt over the plain. But the floods were unpredictable: some years they were too small, other years they destroyed

fields and villages. Summers were hot and rainfall was low.

Farmers solved these problems by working together. They dug irrigation canals to carry river water to fields, built levees to hold back floods, and stored water for dry months. Organizing these big projects required leaders and laws. The region had few trees and little stone, so people built with sun-dried mud bricks and traded grain and cloth for wood, stone, and metal.

Geographic challenge	Human solution
unpredictable floods	levees and drainage ditches
little rain in summer	irrigation canals and storage basins
few trees or stone	mud bricks; trade for resources
flat land, open to invaders	city walls and armies

ACTIVITY · IRRIGATION MODEL

How can canals bring water to fields?

You need: a baking pan with soil or sand; a cup of water; a craft stick.

1 Shape a “river” along one side of the pan.

2 Use the stick to carve canals from the river to three “fields.”

3 Pour water into the river at the high end. Where does it go?

4 Add a small dirt bank (levee) and test it again.

Record: a labeled sketch of your irrigation system and what worked.

★ KEY IDEA

Mesopotamia's rivers gave rich soil and water, but floods and dry summers forced people to cooperate on irrigation and levees.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. What does “Mesopotamia” mean?

Answer: land between the rivers

2. Name the two rivers.

Answer: Tigris and Euphrates

3. Why did Mesopotamians build with mud brick?

Answer: There were few trees and little stone.

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.5

#	Question	Answer
1	Rich soil left by floods	silt
2	Bringing water to crops	irrigation
3	Sketch your irrigation model. Label the river, canals, and fields.	Answers vary. Check that every part is filled in and matches what the student did.
4	What worked? What would you change?	Answers vary. Check that every part is filled in and matches what the student did.
5	What does “Mesopotamia” mean?	land between the rivers
6	Name the two rivers.	Tigris and Euphrates
7	Why did Mesopotamians build with mud brick?	There were few trees and little stone.
8	Use the map. Which body of water do the Tigris and Euphrates flow into? (figure)	the Persian Gulf
9	In which modern country is most of Mesopotamia?	Iraq
10	Which city on the map is farthest south?	Ur
11	Explain how a geographic challenge led to cooperation and government.	Unpredictable floods and dry summers required large irrigation and levee projects that needed leaders and rules.
12	Were the rivers more helpful or harmful to Mesopotamians? Explain.	Answers vary; rich soil and water vs destructive floods.

LESSON 1.6 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 3 · Lesson 2 of 2
Unit 1: Early Humans and Mesopotamia

Lesson 1.6: Sumer: City-States, Ziggurats, and Society

Student goal	I can describe Sumerian city-states, religion, and social classes.
Objective	Students describe Sumerian society.
Standard	C3 D2.His.1.6-8, D2.Civ.6.6-8 — Analyze connections; describe government and social structure.
Pacing	Unit 1, week 3, lesson 2 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Blocks or sugar cubes, workbook Lesson 1.6
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Town with its own king.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson.
Analyze	10	Discuss social pyramid; religion and power.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook. The Weekly Check comes next.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Assuming all ancient women had no rights.

SUPPORT

- Social pyramid diagram.

EXTEND

- Research the Royal Tombs of Ur.

STUDENT LESSON 1.6 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.6: Sumer: City-States, Ziggurats, and Society

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 1.6, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 1.6 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity, Design a Ziggurat, on your Activity Sheet (Workbook Lesson 1.6, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.6, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 1.6: Parts D–E.

THINK ABOUT IT

If your town had its own king, army, and gods, how would you feel about the next town over?

By about 3500 BCE, the people of Sumer, in southern Mesopotamia, had built some of the world's first cities, including Ur and Uruk. Each was a city-state with its own ruler, army, and patron god. City-states often fought over water and land.

Sumerians practiced polytheism. They believed gods controlled nature and that people must serve them. At the center of each city stood a ziggurat, a huge stepped tower of mud brick with a temple on top. Priests were powerful, and at first they helped manage the city's grain. Over time, war leaders became kings, who claimed to rule with the gods' approval.

Social class	Who
upper class	kings, priests, and nobles
middle class	merchants, artisans, scribes, farmers who owned land
lower class	farm workers and laborers
enslaved people	often prisoners of war or people in debt

Women in Sumer could own property and run businesses, and some were priestesses, but most power belonged to men.

ACTIVITY · DESIGN A ZIGGURAT

What did a ziggurat show about Sumerian values?

You need: sugar cubes or building blocks; paper.

1 Build a three-level stepped tower with a shrine on top.

2 Add a ramp or stairway.

3 Write two sentences explaining why the temple was the tallest building in the city.

Record: a sketch and your explanation.

★ KEY IDEA

Sumer was made of independent city-states centered on ziggurats, ruled by kings and priests, with clear social classes.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Name two Sumerian city-states.

Answer: Ur and Uruk (also Lagash, Kish)

2. What was a ziggurat?

Answer: a stepped temple tower

3. Why did city-states fight?

Answer: over water and land

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.6

#	Question	Answer
1	Belief in many gods	polytheism
2	A city with its own government	city-state
3	Sketch your ziggurat. Label the temple, stairs, and levels.	Answers vary. Check that every part is filled in and matches what the student did.
4	Explain your design.	Answers vary. Check that every part is filled in and matches what the student did.
5	Name two Sumerian city-states.	Ur and Uruk (also Lagash, Kish)
6	What was a ziggurat?	a stepped temple tower
7	Why did city-states fight?	over water and land
8	Who was at the top of Sumerian society?	kings, priests, nobles
9	Name one right Sumerian women had.	own property, run businesses
10	Why were scribes respected?	Few people could read and write.

#	Question	Answer
11	What does the location and size of the ziggurat suggest about the role of religion in Sumer?	Religion was central and powerful; the temple dominated the city.
12	Compare a Sumerian city-state with a modern U.S. city.	Answers vary; e.g. both have government and jobs; Sumer had kings, its own army, and patron gods.

WEEKLY CHECK · ANSWER KEY
After Lesson 1.6

About 15 minutes

Weekly Check 3: Mesopotamia and Sumer — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	The two rivers of Mesopotamia	Tigris and Euphrates
2	Bringing water to crops through canals	irrigation
3	A stepped temple tower	ziggurat
4	Belief in many gods	polytheism
5	Describe one geographic challenge in Mesopotamia and how people solved it.	e.g. unpredictable floods → levees; dry summers → irrigation canals.

LESSON 1.7 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 4 · Lesson 1 of 2
Unit 1: Early Humans and Mesopotamia

Lesson 1.7: Cuneiform and the Invention of Writing

Student goal	I can explain how and why writing developed in Sumer and how it changed society.
Objective	Students explain the development of writing.
Standard	C3 D2.His.1.6-8 — Analyze connections among developments.
Pacing	Unit 1, week 4, lesson 1 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Clay, craft sticks, workbook Lesson 1.7
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	No writing.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson.
Analyze	10	Discuss stages of writing; Gilgamesh summary.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook lesson pages: Warm-Up through Exit Ticket.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Thinking writing was invented for stories first.

SUPPORT

- Picture → symbol chart.

EXTEND

- Look up your name in a cuneiform chart.

STUDENT LESSON 1.7 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.7: Cuneiform and the Invention of Writing

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

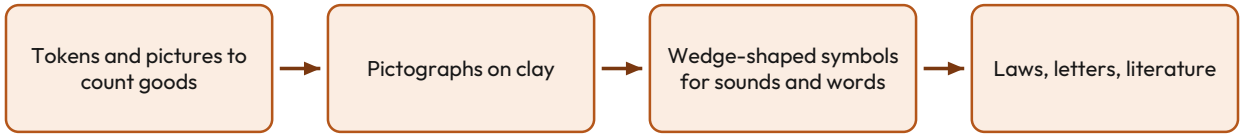
- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 1.7, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 1.7 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity, Clay Tablet Scribe, on your Activity Sheet (Workbook Lesson 1.7, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.7, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 1.7: Parts D–E.

THINK ABOUT IT

How would your life change if nothing could be written down?

Around 3200 BCE, Sumerians in cities like Uruk began keeping records on clay tablets. At first they drew small pictures to count grain, sheep, and taxes. Over time the pictures became wedge-shaped marks pressed with a reed stylus: cuneiform, from the Latin word for "wedge." Cuneiform was used for more than 3,000 years and for many languages.

Writing was hard to learn, so scribes trained for years in schools. They wrote contracts, laws, letters, medical texts, prayers, and literature, including the Epic of Gilgamesh, one of the oldest stories in the world. It tells of Gilgamesh, a king of Uruk, who searches for the secret of living forever and learns that every human life must end.



Other Sumerian innovations include the wheel (used for pottery and carts), the plow, sailboats, and a number system based on 60, which is why we still have 60 minutes in an hour and 360 degrees in a circle.

ACTIVITY · CLAY TABLET SCRIBE

What was it like to write in cuneiform?

You need: air-dry clay or play dough; a craft stick cut to a wedge point or a chopstick.

1 Flatten the clay into a tablet.

2 Press wedge shapes to record a "receipt": 5 sheep and 3 jars of barley (invent symbols).

3 Trade tablets with a partner and try to read each other's record.

Record: your symbol key and two problems a scribe would face.

★ KEY IDEA

Writing began as record keeping, became cuneiform, and let people keep laws, history, and literature.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. What was cuneiform first used for?

Answer: keeping records of goods, trade, and taxes

2. What does cuneiform mean?

Answer: wedge-shaped

3. Who was Gilgamesh?

Answer: a king of Uruk, hero of the epic

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.7

#	Question	Answer
1	Tool used to write on clay	stylus
2	A long poem about a hero	epic
3	Record your symbol key. (figure)	Answers vary. Check that every part is filled in and matches what the student did.
4	Two problems a scribe would face:	Answers vary. Check that every part is filled in and matches what the student did.
5	What was cuneiform first used for?	keeping records of goods, trade, and taxes
6	What does cuneiform mean?	wedge-shaped
7	Who was Gilgamesh?	a king of Uruk, hero of the epic
8	About when did writing begin in Sumer?	about 3200 BCE
9	Why did scribes train for years?	Cuneiform had hundreds of signs and was hard to learn.
10	Name a Sumerian idea we still use.	60 minutes in an hour / 360 degrees in a circle / the wheel

#	Question	Answer
11	Explain how writing helped governments become more powerful.	Rulers could record taxes, laws, and property, and send orders across distances.
12	Which Sumerian invention do you think was most important? Defend your choice.	Answers vary.

LESSON 1.8 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 4 · Lesson 2 of 2
Unit 1: Early Humans and Mesopotamia

Lesson 1.8: Empires and the Code of Hammurabi

Student goal	I can describe the first empires and analyze Hammurabi's Code as a primary source.
Objective	Students analyze the first empires and Hammurabi's Code.
Standard	C3 D2.Civ.3.6-8, D2.His.10.6-8 — Examine the origins, purposes, and impact of laws; analyze primary sources.
Pacing	Unit 1, week 4, lesson 2 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Highlighters, workbook Lesson 1.8, Unit 1 Review
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Written laws.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson. Read the source excerpt aloud.
Analyze	10	Model source analysis.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook; then the Unit 1 Review.
Exit Ticket	3	Next: Unit 1 Test.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Judging ancient law only by modern values without context.

SUPPORT

- Source-analysis questions: who, when, why, what's missing?

EXTEND

- Write a fair code of five family rules.

STUDENT LESSON 1.8 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.8: Empires and the Code of Hammurabi

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 1.8, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 1.8 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity, Fair or Unfair?, on your Activity Sheet (Workbook Lesson 1.8, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.8, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 1.8: Parts D–E.

THINK ABOUT IT

Why might it matter that laws are written down for everyone to see?

Around 2334 BCE, Sargon of Akkad conquered the Sumerian city-states and created what many historians call the world's first empire. Later, Hammurabi, king of Babylon (ruled about 1792–1750 BCE), united much of Mesopotamia. About 1754 BCE he had 282 laws carved on a tall stone stele for public display. The stele is now in the Louvre museum in Paris.

READING · PRIMARY SOURCE

From the Code of Hammurabi

Babylon, about 1754 BCE. Translated by L. W. King (1910). Public domain.

196. If a man put out the eye of another man, his eye shall be put out.

198. If he put out the eye of a freed man, or break the bone of a freed man, he shall pay one gold mina.

199. If he put out the eye of a man's slave, or break the bone of a man's slave, he shall pay one-half of its value.

229. If a builder build a house for some one, and does not construct it properly, and the house which he built fall in and kill its owner, then that builder shall be put to death.

LOOK CLOSER · ANALYZE A PRIMARY SOURCE

What do Laws 196, 198, and 199 reveal about Babylonian society?

1 Law 196: harming another man means the same harm in return ("an eye for an eye").

2 Law 198: harming a freed man means paying a fine (one gold mina) instead.

3 Law 199: harming an enslaved person means paying the owner.

Answer: Punishments depended on social class, so Babylonian law treated people unequally; laws protected property and order more than equal rights.

Hammurabi's Code was not the first law code, but it is one of the best preserved. By writing laws in public, he showed that rules applied across his empire, and he claimed the gods gave him authority to rule justly.

ACTIVITY · FAIR OR UNFAIR?

Do these laws match our ideas of justice?

You need: the source excerpt; highlighters.

1 Highlight each punishment.

2 Rate each law from 1 (very unfair) to 5 (very fair) by today's standards.

3 Find one idea in the code that is similar to modern law (for example, builders responsible for safe buildings).

Record: your ratings and a paragraph comparing Hammurabi's Code with modern laws.

★ KEY IDEA

Sargon built the first empire; Hammurabi's written code brought order but punished people differently by class.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Who created the first empire?

Answer: Sargon of Akkad

2. About when was Hammurabi's Code written?

Answer: about 1754 BCE

3. Did the code treat all people equally?

Answer: No; punishments depended on social class.

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.8

#	Question	Answer
1	Many lands ruled by one government	empire
2	A tall carved stone slab	stele
3	Record your results in the table. (figure)	Answers vary. Check that every part is filled in and matches what the student did.
4	Compare Hammurabi's Code with modern laws.	Answers vary. Check that every part is filled in and matches what the student did.
5	Who created the first empire?	Sargon of Akkad
6	About when was Hammurabi's Code written?	about 1754 BCE
7	Did the code treat all people equally?	No; punishments depended on social class.
8	What happens to a builder whose house collapses and kills the owner?	The builder is put to death.
9	What is the punishment for putting out a freed man's eye?	paying one gold mina
10	Why would Hammurabi carve his laws in stone in a public place?	So everyone knew the laws and they couldn't easily be changed; to show his authority.
11	Name one way the code is like modern law and one way it is different.	Like: builders responsible for safety. Different: unequal punishments by class; harsh physical punishments.
12	Why was writing laws down an important step for civilization?	Written laws were public, consistent, and harder for rulers to change at will.

UNIT REVIEW · ANSWER KEY
Study before the unit test

About 40 minutes

Unit 1 Review — Answer Key

Homework or a study session before the test.

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	artifact	object made by people in the past
2	domestication	taming plants and animals
3	city-state	a city with its own government
4	cuneiform	wedge-shaped writing
5	empire	many lands under one government
6	surplus	more than needed
7	Explain how geography, farming, and writing each helped Sumer become a civilization.	Rivers gave water and soil; farming gave surplus; writing allowed records and laws.

UNIT TEST · ANSWER KEY
At the end of the unit

About 45 minutes

Unit 1 Test — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Primary or secondary: a clay tablet from Ur	primary
2	Primary or secondary: a documentary about Sumer	secondary
3	Order from earliest: 1754 BCE, 3200 BCE, 2334 BCE	3200 BCE, 2334 BCE, 1754 BCE
4	How many years from 2000 BCE to 1500 BCE?	500
5	How did most Paleolithic people get food? A. farming B. trading in cities C. hunting and gathering D. fishing fleets	C. hunting and gathering
6	What is domestication?	taming plants and animals for human use
7	Name one benefit and one problem of farming.	e.g. surplus / disease or harder work
8	Which came first? A. cities B. food surplus C. writing	B. food surplus
9	Use the map. Which labeled city is farthest south, closest to the Persian Gulf? (figure)	Ur
10	Why did Mesopotamians need irrigation?	Little rain in summer; needed to bring river water to crops.
11	What was a ziggurat?	a stepped temple tower
12	What was cuneiform first used for?	keeping records (goods, taxes, trade)
13	Who created the first empire?	Sargon of Akkad
14	Reread the excerpt from Hammurabi's Code. What does it show about justice and social class in Babylon? Use two laws as evidence.	Rubric: claim that punishments depended on class (1); two laws cited accurately (1); explanation of what this reveals (1).
15	Explain how the geography of Mesopotamia led to the development of government and laws.	Rubric: describes the rivers/floods/dry climate (1); explains irrigation and levee projects (1); connects cooperation to leaders and government (1); connects government to written laws (1).

Scoring

Score	What it means / next step
17–20 (85%+)	Mastered.
14–16	Proficient; review missed skills.
Below 14	Reteach and retest.

UNIT 2 · TEACHER OVERVIEW

River Valley Civilizations

Ancient Egypt and Kush, the Indus Valley, Hinduism and Buddhism, and ancient China from the Shang to the Han.

Mesopotamia was not the only place where people built cities beside a river. In this unit you'll travel up the Nile to the pyramids of Egypt and Kush, walk the planned streets of the Indus Valley, learn the beliefs that shaped India, and follow China from oracle bones to the Great Wall and the Silk Road. Then you'll compare the first civilizations and decide what each one left the world.

Big ideas

- Explain how rivers shaped Egypt, the Indus Valley, and China.
- Describe Egyptian and Kushite government, beliefs, and trade.
- Explain the main beliefs of Hinduism and Buddhism.
- Explain China's dynasties, the Mandate of Heaven, and Confucian ideas.
- Compare the four river valley civilizations.

Standards

Code	Standard
C3 D2.His.1, 2, 4, 10	Context; change and continuity; perspectives; limits of sources.
C3 D2.Geo.2, 4	Maps; human–environment interaction.
C3 D2.Civ.6	How political ideas shape government.

What students should already know

- Unit 1: civilization, irrigation, cuneiform, and the Fertile Crescent.

Materials for the unit

- Tray, soil, and muddy water

- Graph paper and ruler
- Paper plates
- Index cards
- World map or atlas

Pacing guide

Teach the lessons in order, then give the week's check. Set the days to fit your own calendar.

Week	Order	Lesson	Title
Week 1	Lesson 1 of 2	2.1	Egypt: Gift of the Nile
Week 1	Lesson 2 of 2	2.2	Pharaohs, Pyramids, and the Afterlife
Week 1	End of week	Check	Weekly Check 1: Ancient Egypt
Week 2	Lesson 1 of 2	2.3	Egypt and Kush: Trade and Power
Week 2	Lesson 2 of 2	2.4	The Indus Valley Civilization
Week 2	End of week	Check	Weekly Check 2: Kush and the Indus Valley
Week 3	Lesson 1 of 2	2.5	Hinduism, Buddhism, and the Maurya Empire
Week 3	Lesson 2 of 2	2.6	China: The Huang He and the Shang Dynasty
Week 3	End of week	Check	Weekly Check 3: India's Beliefs and Early China
Week 4	Lesson 1 of 2	2.7	Zhou, Qin, and Han: Confucius, the Great Wall, and the Silk Road
Week 4	Lesson 2 of 2	2.8	Comparing River Valley Civilizations
Week 4	Before the test	Review	Unit 2 Review
Week 4	End of unit	Test	Unit 2 Test

TEACHING THIS UNIT AT HOME

Find the Nile, Indus, and Huang He on a world map together, then look up one museum artifact from each civilization online.

UNIT VOCABULARY

silt	Rich soil left by water.
pharaoh	Egypt's ruler, seen as a god.
cultural diffusion	The spread of ideas.
karma	Actions decide the future.
dynasty	Rulers from one family.
Mandate of Heaven	Heaven's approval to rule.

LESSON 2.1 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 1 · Lesson 1 of 2
Unit 2: River Valley Civilizations

Lesson 2.1: Egypt: Gift of the Nile

Student goal	I can explain how the Nile River shaped where and how ancient Egyptians lived.
Objective	Students explain how the Nile shaped Egyptian civilization.
Standard	C3 D2.Geo.4.6-8, D2.His.1.6-8 — Explain how physical geography shaped settlement and economic activity.
Pacing	Unit 2, week 1, lesson 1 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Tray, soil, muddy water, workbook Lesson 2.1
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Feeding millions with no rain.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson; study the map.
Analyze	10	Model the flood cycle. Compare with Mesopotamia.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook lesson pages: Warm-Up through Exit Ticket.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Upper/Lower Egypt reversed on the map.

SUPPORT

- Flood-cycle diagram: flood, silt, plant, harvest.

EXTEND

- Research the Aswan High Dam and how it ended the inundation.

STUDENT LESSON 2.1 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 2.1: Egypt: Gift of the Nile

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 2.1, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 2.1 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity, Flood Model, on your Activity Sheet (Workbook Lesson 2.1, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.1, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 2.1: Parts D–E.

THINK ABOUT IT

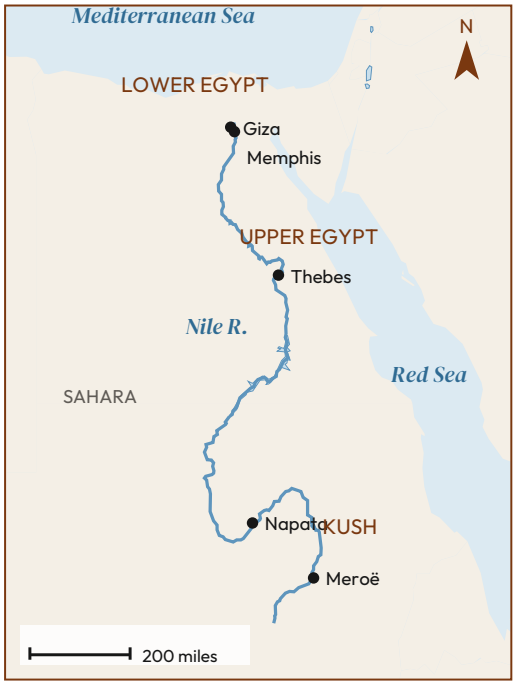
Egypt gets almost no rain, yet it fed millions of people for thousands of years. How is that possible?

The Greek writer Herodotus called Egypt "the gift of the Nile." The Nile is the world's longest river, about 4,100 miles. Unlike most rivers, it flows north, from the mountains of East Africa to the Mediterranean Sea.

Almost all Egyptians lived on a narrow green strip along the river. Beyond it lay the Sahara, the "red land" of desert that also protected Egypt from invaders.

Because the Nile flows north, Upper Egypt is in the south and Lower Egypt is in the north, around the delta.

The Nile Valley



Every summer, rains far to the south made the Nile rise. During the inundation, the river spread over its banks. When the water went down in the fall, it left a layer of black silt, and farmers planted wheat, barley, and flax in the "black land." Farmers used a shaduf, a bucket on a pole, to lift water into irrigation canals. Rocky rapids called cataracts to the south made boat travel difficult there.

Feature of the Nile	How it helped Egyptians
yearly flood and silt	rich soil for crops and a food surplus
flows north; winds blow south	boats could float north and sail south: easy trade
papyrus reeds along the banks	paper, rope, sandals, and boats
deserts on both sides	natural protection from invaders

Around 3100 BCE, a king of Upper Egypt, traditionally called Narmer or Menes, unified Upper and Lower Egypt into one kingdom. Egyptian history is divided into the Old, Middle, and New Kingdoms, with more than 30 ruling families, or dynasties, over about 3,000 years.

ACTIVITY · FLOOD MODEL

How did the inundation make farmland?

You need: a long pan or tray; soil; a cup of muddy water; a spoon.

1. Spread dry soil in the tray and press a groove for the river.
2. Slowly pour the muddy water down the groove until it spills over the banks.
3. Let it sit, then pour off the extra water.
4. Look at what is left on the "fields."

Record: a labeled sketch and two sentences explaining how flood silt helped Egyptian farmers.

! WATCH OUT

On maps, "Upper" Egypt is at the bottom and "Lower" Egypt is at the top. The names come from the river's flow: upriver is south.

★ KEY IDEA

The Nile's yearly flood left rich silt for farming, its current and winds made trade easy, and the deserts protected Egypt. Egypt was unified around 3100 BCE.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. In which direction does the Nile flow?

Answer: north

2. What did the inundation leave behind?

Answer: rich black silt

3. Why is Upper Egypt in the south?

Answer: It is upriver; the Nile flows north from the south.

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 2.1

#	Question	Answer
1	The yearly Nile flood	inundation
2	Rich soil left by water	silt
3	Sketch your flood model before and after the flood. Label the river, the flood, and the silt.	Answers vary. Check that every part is filled in and matches what the student did.
4	How did flood silt help Egyptian farmers?	The flood left rich black silt that made the soil fertile for crops.
5	In which direction does the Nile flow?	north
6	What did the inundation leave behind?	rich black silt
7	Why is Upper Egypt in the south?	It is upriver; the Nile flows north from the south.
8	What did Egyptians call the desert?	the red land
9	What tool lifted water into canals?	the shaduf
10	Name two uses of papyrus.	e.g. paper, rope, sandals, boats
11	Who traditionally unified Egypt, and about when?	Narmer (Menes), about 3100 BCE
12	Compare the Nile with the Tigris and Euphrates (Unit 1). Give one similarity and one difference.	Similar: floods left rich soil and supported farming. Different: the Nile's flood was regular and predictable; Mesopotamia's floods were unpredictable.
13	Explain why Herodotus called Egypt “the gift of the Nile.” Use two details.	e.g. the flood's silt made farming possible in a desert; the river gave water, transport, and papyrus.

LESSON 2.2 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 1 · Lesson 2 of 2
Unit 2: River Valley Civilizations

Lesson 2.2: Pharaohs, Pyramids, and the Afterlife

Student goal	I can explain how Egyptian beliefs about pharaohs and the afterlife shaped their government, art, and buildings.
Objective	Students connect Egyptian beliefs to government, art, and architecture.
Standard	C3 D2.His.2.6-8, D2.Civ.6.6-8 — Explain how belief systems shaped governments and cultures.
Pacing	Unit 2, week 1, lesson 2 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Paper, markers, hieroglyph chart, workbook Lesson 2.2
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Twenty years for one tomb.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson.
Analyze	10	Model the tomb-goods inference. Discuss who built the pyramids and how we know.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook. The Weekly Check comes next.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Believing pyramids were built by enslaved armies.

SUPPORT

- Cause-and-effect organizer: belief → practice.

EXTEND

- Take a virtual tour of the Giza pyramids.

STUDENT LESSON 2.2 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 2.2: Pharaohs, Pyramids, and the Afterlife

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 2.2, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 2.2 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity, Cartouche, on your Activity Sheet (Workbook Lesson 2.2, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.2, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 2.2: Parts D–E.

THINK ABOUT IT

Why would people spend 20 years building one tomb?

Egyptians believed their king, the pharaoh, was a god on Earth who kept ma'at: order, truth, and balance. Because the ruler was divine, Egypt was a theocracy. The pharaoh owned all the land, led the army, and ran the government through officials called viziers and scribes.

Egyptians were polytheists who worshiped many gods, such as Ra, the sun god, and Osiris, god of the afterlife. They believed the dead needed their bodies in the next life, so priests made mummies, a 70-day process of drying and wrapping the body. Tombs held food, furniture, and treasures for the journey.

Old Kingdom pharaohs built pyramids as tombs. The Great Pyramid at Giza, built for the pharaoh Khufu around 2560 BCE, used more than two million stone blocks. Archaeologists have found that it was built by paid, skilled workers and farm laborers during the flood season, not by enslaved armies. Later pharaohs were buried in hidden tombs in the Valley of the Kings, such as the tomb of Tutankhamun, found in 1922.

Egyptians wrote with hieroglyphics, more than 700 picture symbols, on stone and papyrus. For centuries no one could read them. Then, in 1799, French soldiers found the Rosetta Stone, carved with the same message in hieroglyphics, a later Egyptian script, and Greek. In 1822, Jean-François Champollion used the Greek to decode the hieroglyphs.

LOOK CLOSER · USE EVIDENCE TO MAKE AN INFERENCE

Tombs were filled with bread, jars of beer, furniture, games, and small statues of servants.

1 Evidence: the objects are things people use in daily life.

2 Background: Egyptians believed in an afterlife.

3 Inference: they expected the dead to need these things in the next life.

Answer: Tomb goods show that Egyptians believed the afterlife was much like life on Earth.

ACTIVITY · CARTOUCHE

How did hieroglyphs represent sounds?

You need: paper; pencil and markers; a hieroglyph alphabet chart (print one from a museum website).

1 Draw a long oval with a line at one end: a cartouche, which held a pharaoh's name.

2 Spell your name with the hieroglyph sound chart, from top to bottom.

3 Decorate the border.

4 Trade with a family member and have them decode it.

Record: your cartouche and one sentence explaining why the Rosetta Stone mattered.

★ KEY IDEA

Egyptians saw the pharaoh as a god, so religion and government were joined. Belief in the afterlife led to mummies, tomb goods, and pyramids. The Rosetta Stone unlocked hieroglyphics.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Why was Egypt a theocracy?

Answer: The pharaoh was believed to be a god and ruled the government.

2. Why did Egyptians make mummies?

Answer: They believed the dead needed their bodies in the afterlife.

3. How did the Rosetta Stone help scholars read hieroglyphics?

Answer: It had the same text in Greek, which scholars could read.

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 2.2

#	Question	Answer
1	Life after death	afterlife
2	Egyptian picture writing	hieroglyphics
3	Design your cartouche here.	Answers vary. Check that every part is filled in and matches what the student did.

#	Question	Answer
4	Why did the Rosetta Stone matter?	It had the same text in three scripts, so scholars like Champollion could decode hieroglyphics.
5	Why was Egypt a theocracy?	The pharaoh was believed to be a god and ruled the government.
6	Why did Egyptians make mummies?	They believed the dead needed their bodies in the afterlife.
7	How did the Rosetta Stone help scholars read hieroglyphics?	It had the same text in Greek, which scholars could read.
8	What was ma'at?	order, truth, and balance
9	Which god ruled the afterlife?	Osiris
10	For which pharaoh was the Great Pyramid built?	Khufu
11	Who decoded hieroglyphics, and when?	Champollion, 1822
12	What does the way the Great Pyramid was built tell us about Egypt's government and economy? Give two details.	A strong government could organize and feed thousands of workers; the food surplus from the Nile paid them.
13	How were religion and government connected in ancient Egypt?	The pharaoh was seen as a god, so obeying the government was a religious duty.

WEEKLY CHECK · ANSWER KEY
After Lesson 2.2

About 15 minutes

Weekly Check 1: Ancient Egypt — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Direction the Nile flows	north
2	The yearly Nile flood	inundation
3	Egyptian picture writing	hieroglyphics
4	Artifact that helped decode hieroglyphics	the Rosetta Stone
5	Government led by a ruler seen as divine	theocracy
6	How did the Nile make farming possible in a desert?	Its yearly flood left rich silt and water for crops.

LESSON 2.3 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 2 · Lesson 1 of 2
Unit 2: River Valley Civilizations

Lesson 2.3: Egypt and Kush: Trade and Power

Student goal	I can describe how Egypt and Kush influenced each other through trade, conquest, and culture.
Objective	Students analyze Egypt–Kush interactions.
Standard	C3 D2.His.2.6-8, D2.Eco.15.6-8 — Explain how trade and conquest spread ideas.
Pacing	Unit 2, week 2, lesson 1 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Nile maps, colored pencils, workbook Lesson 2.3
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Neighbors over 2,000 years.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson and chart.
Analyze	10	Model cultural diffusion examples. Show photos of Meroë's pyramids.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook lesson pages: Warm-Up through Exit Ticket.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Thinking Kush was only a part of Egypt.

SUPPORT

- Two-way trade arrows organizer.

EXTEND

- Research Queen Amanirenas of Kush and her war with Rome.

STUDENT LESSON 2.3 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 2.3: Egypt and Kush: Trade and Power

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 2.3, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 2.3 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity, Trade Map, on your Activity Sheet (Workbook Lesson 2.3, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.3, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 2.3: Parts D–E.

THINK ABOUT IT

Two neighbors trade, fight, and borrow ideas from each other for 2,000 years. How might each one change?

South of Egypt, past the cataracts, lay Nubia, home of the kingdom of Kush. Nubia was rich in gold, ebony wood, ivory, and incense. Egypt traded with Kush, and at times New Kingdom pharaohs conquered it. Kushites adopted Egyptian gods, writing, and pyramid tombs: this is cultural diffusion.

Egyptian trade reached far. The female pharaoh Hatshepsut (ruled about 1479–1458 BCE) sent a famous trading expedition to the land of Punt, returning with incense trees, gold, and animals. Ramses II (ruled about 1279–1213 BCE) expanded Egypt's power with wars and huge monuments.

Then the tables turned. Around 750 BCE, the Kushite king Piye conquered Egypt, and Kushite kings ruled as pharaohs for nearly a century. Later, Kush moved its capital south to Meroë, which became a center of iron-making and trade. Meroë's kings built more than 200 steep pyramids, more than in all of Egypt.

	Egypt	Kush
location	lower Nile, north of the cataracts	upper Nile, in Nubia
exports	grain, linen, papyrus	gold, ivory, ebony, iron, incense
capital cities	Memphis, Thebes	Napata, then Meroë
shared culture	gods, pyramids, hieroglyphs	adopted Egyptian gods, pyramids, and writing; later its own Meroitic script

ACTIVITY · TRADE MAP

What moved between Egypt and Kush?

You need: a copy of the Nile Valley map; colored pencils.

1. Trace the Nile from Meroë to the delta.
2. Draw arrows for goods moving north (from Kush) and south (from Egypt), using the chart.
3. Label each arrow with two goods.
4. Add a symbol for one idea that spread by cultural diffusion.

Record: your labeled trade map.

★ KEY IDEA

Egypt and Kush traded, fought, and shared ideas for centuries. Kush adopted Egyptian ways, conquered Egypt around 750 BCE, and later thrived at Meroë as an iron-making center.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Name two goods Kush traded.

Answer: e.g. gold, ivory, ebony, iron, incense

2. Which Kushite king conquered Egypt around 750 BCE?

Answer: Piye

3. Give an example of cultural diffusion between Egypt and Kush.

Answer: e.g. Kush adopted Egyptian gods, pyramids, and hieroglyphs.

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 2.3

#	Question	Answer
1	The spread of ideas between groups	cultural diffusion
2	A good sent elsewhere to be sold	export
3	Draw your trade map. Label Egypt, Kush, the Nile, and the goods that moved each way.	Answers vary. Check that every part is filled in and matches what the student did.
4	Name two goods Kush traded.	e.g. gold, ivory, ebony, iron, incense
5	Which Kushite king conquered Egypt around 750 BCE?	Piye
6	Give an example of cultural diffusion between Egypt and Kush.	e.g. Kush adopted Egyptian gods, pyramids, and hieroglyphs.
7	Where was Kush?	in Nubia, south of Egypt along the Nile
8	Where did Hatshepsut send a trade expedition?	the land of Punt
9	What was Meroë known for?	iron-making, trade, and many pyramids
10	Which kingdom built more pyramids?	Kush
11	How did the relationship between Egypt and Kush change over time? Give two examples.	e.g. Egypt traded with and conquered Kush; later Kush conquered Egypt and ruled as pharaohs.
12	Why do you think Kush adopted so many Egyptian customs?	e.g. long contact through trade and conquest; Egyptian ideas showed power and prestige.

LESSON 2.4 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 2 · Lesson 2 of 2
Unit 2: River Valley Civilizations

Lesson 2.4: The Indus Valley Civilization

Student goal	I can describe the planned cities of the Indus Valley and explain what archaeologists still don't know about them.
Objective	Students describe Indus Valley cities and the limits of evidence.
Standard	C3 D2.His.10.6-8, D2.Geo.2.6-8 — Explain the limitations of historical sources; use maps to explain places.
Pacing	Unit 2, week 2, lesson 2 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Graph paper, rulers, workbook Lesson 2.4
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Keeping 40,000 people clean.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson; study the map.
Analyze	10	Model the evidence-and-limits example.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook. The Weekly Check comes next.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Stating guesses about the Indus as facts.

SUPPORT

- Know / Think / Don't-know chart.

EXTEND

- Look at photos of Indus seals and invent a guess about their meaning.

STUDENT LESSON 2.4 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 2.4: The Indus Valley Civilization

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 2.4, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 2.4 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity, Plan a City, on your Activity Sheet (Workbook Lesson 2.4, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.4, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 2.4: Parts D–E.

THINK ABOUT IT

What would a city need to keep 40,000 people healthy and clean, without any electricity?

The Indus and Ganges valleys



The Indus and Ganges rivers flow from the Himalayas.

Around 2600 BCE, a civilization grew along the Indus River in what is now Pakistan and northwestern India. Snow melting from the Himalayas and summer monsoon rains flooded the river and left rich silt, like the Nile. Its largest cities, Harappa and Mohenjo-daro, may each have held tens of thousands of people.

Indus cities were carefully planned. Streets ran in straight lines in a grid. Houses were built of baked bricks of the same size. Many homes had bathrooms, and covered drains carried waste away under the streets, a system more advanced than many cities had thousands of years later. A raised citadel held large buildings, such as the Great Bath at Mohenjo-daro. Traders used standardized stone weights and carved seals, some of which have been found as far away as Mesopotamia.

Much about this civilization is still a mystery. Its writing, found on more than 4,000 small seals, has never been deciphered, so we can't read their own words. Around 1900 BCE, the cities declined. Historians think climate change, shifting rivers, and failing trade may have played a part.

LOOK CLOSER · WHAT EVIDENCE CAN AND CAN'T TELL US

Archaeologists found no grand palaces or royal tombs at Mohenjo-daro.

1 Evidence: large public buildings, but no palaces or rich royal tombs.

2 Possible inference: power may have been shared, or rulers did not display wealth.

3 Limit: without readable writing, we can't confirm who ruled.

Answer: Artifacts suggest a well-organized society, but historians must say “may” until the script is read.

ACTIVITY · PLAN A CITY

Can you design a city as organized as Mohenjo-daro?

You need: graph paper; a pencil and ruler.

1 Draw a grid of streets running north–south and east–west.

2 Add a raised citadel with one public building.

3 Draw homes and a drain line under every street that leads away from the city.

4 Add a market and a granary.

Record: your city plan with a key and two sentences comparing it with Mohenjo-daro.

★ KEY IDEA

The Indus Valley civilization built planned grid cities with drains and standardized bricks and weights. Its writing hasn't been deciphered, so much remains a mystery.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Name two cities of the Indus Valley.

Answer: Harappa and Mohenjo-daro

2. Name one sign that Indus cities were planned.

Answer: e.g. grid streets, drains, same-size bricks

3. Why do historians know less about the Indus Valley than about Egypt?

Answer: Its writing has never been deciphered.

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 2.4

#	Question	Answer
1	A seasonal wind that brings heavy rain	monsoon
2	Made the same everywhere	standardized
3	Draw your city plan. Include a key.	Answers vary. Check that every part is filled in and matches what the student did.
4	Compare your plan with Mohenjo-daro.	Answers vary. Check that every part is filled in and matches what the student did.
5	Name two cities of the Indus Valley.	Harappa and Mohenjo-daro
6	Name one sign that Indus cities were planned.	e.g. grid streets, drains, same-size bricks
7	Why do historians know less about the Indus Valley than about Egypt?	Its writing has never been deciphered.
8	In which modern countries was the Indus Valley civilization?	Pakistan and northwestern India
9	What carried waste away under the streets?	covered drains
10	Where have Indus seals been found far from home?	Mesopotamia
11	About when did the cities decline?	around 1900 BCE
12	What does the use of standardized weights suggest about Indus trade and government? Explain.	Fair, organized trade; some authority set and enforced the standards.
13	Write one thing historians know about the Indus Valley and one thing they don't. Explain why the second is uncertain.	e.g. know: grid cities and drains; don't know: who ruled, because the script is unread.

WEEKLY CHECK · ANSWER KEY
After Lesson 2.4

About 15 minutes

Weekly Check 2: Kush and the Indus Valley — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Kingdom south of Egypt in Nubia	Kush
2	Kushite city known for iron-making	Meroë
3	The spread of ideas between groups	cultural diffusion
4	Two Indus Valley cities	Harappa and Mohenjo-daro
5	A sign of Indus city planning	e.g. grid streets, drains, same-size bricks
6	Why is much about the Indus Valley still a mystery?	Its writing has never been deciphered.

LESSON 2.5 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 3 · Lesson 1 of 2
Unit 2: River Valley Civilizations

Lesson 2.5: Hinduism, Buddhism, and the Maurya Empire

Student goal	I can explain the main beliefs of Hinduism and Buddhism and how Ashoka spread Buddhist ideas.
Objective	Students explain Hindu and Buddhist beliefs and Ashoka's reign.
Standard	C3 D2.His.2.6-8, D2.His.4.6-8 — Explain how belief systems developed and spread.
Pacing	Unit 2, week 3, lesson 1 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Workbook Lesson 2.5
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Actions come back to you.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson and comparison chart.
Analyze	10	Present each religion respectfully, in its own terms. Discuss Ashoka's change of heart.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook lesson pages: Warm-Up through Exit Ticket.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Describing living religions only in the past tense.

SUPPORT

- Two-column belief organizer.

EXTEND

- Read a translated edict of Ashoka and summarize it.

STUDENT LESSON 2.5 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 2.5: Hinduism, Buddhism, and the Maurya Empire

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 2.5, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 2.5 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.5, Part B.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 2.5: Parts C–D.

THINK ABOUT IT

If you believed every action you took would come back to you, how would you act?

After the Indus cities declined, new ways of life spread across northern India, especially in the Ganges River valley. Sacred hymns called the Vedas were memorized and passed down for centuries. From these traditions grew Hinduism, one of the world's oldest religions.

Hindus believe in dharma (one's duty), karma (actions bring results), and reincarnation (the soul is reborn many times). Society was organized into a caste system of four main groups, or varnas: priests (Brahmins), rulers and warriors, merchants and farmers, and laborers. Some people were placed outside the system entirely and treated unfairly. India's constitution outlawed caste discrimination in 1950.

Around 2,500 years ago, a prince named Siddhartha Gautama gave up his wealth to understand why people suffer. After years of searching, he reached enlightenment and became known as the Buddha, the “awakened one.” He taught the Four Noble Truths: life includes suffering; suffering comes from desire; suffering can end; and the way to end it is the Eightfold Path of right thinking and right living. Buddhism welcomed people of every caste.

The Maurya Empire united most of India in the 300s BCE. Its greatest ruler, Ashoka, conquered the kingdom of Kalinga around 261 BCE in a war that killed many thousands. Horrified, Ashoka became a Buddhist. He carved edicts on stone pillars across his empire urging kindness, honesty, and respect for all religions, and he sent teachers who spread Buddhism to other lands.

	Hinduism	Buddhism
began	grew over centuries from the Vedas	teachings of the Buddha, about 2,500 years ago
key beliefs	dharma, karma, reincarnation; many forms of the divine	Four Noble Truths; Eightfold Path; karma and rebirth
goal	moksha: release from the cycle of rebirth	nirvana: freedom from suffering
caste	society organized by caste	open to people of every caste

★ KEY IDEA

Hinduism teaches dharma, karma, and reincarnation. Buddhism teaches the Four Noble Truths and the Eightfold Path. The Maurya emperor Ashoka spread Buddhist ideas of peace and kindness.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. What is karma?

Answer: the idea that actions decide what happens to a person in the future

2. Who became the Buddha?

Answer: Siddhartha Gautama

3. Why did Ashoka become a Buddhist?

Answer: He was horrified by the killing in his war against Kalinga.

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 2.5

#	Question	Answer
1	Belief that the soul is reborn	reincarnation
2	The oldest Hindu texts	the Vedas
3	What is karma?	the idea that actions decide what happens to a person in the future
4	Who became the Buddha?	Siddhartha Gautama
5	Why did Ashoka become a Buddhist?	He was horrified by the killing in his war against Kalinga.
6	What does dharma mean?	one's duty
7	What is the Buddhist goal of freedom from suffering called?	nirvana

#	Question	Answer
8	What path did the Buddha teach to end suffering?	the Eightfold Path
9	How did Ashoka share his ideas?	edicts carved on stone pillars; he sent teachers
10	Name one way Hinduism and Buddhism are alike and one way they differ.	Alike: karma and rebirth. Different: Buddhism rejected caste; Hinduism organized society by caste.
11	How did Ashoka change after the war with Kalinga, and why does it matter?	He turned to Buddhism and ruled by kindness and tolerance, spreading Buddhism beyond India.

LESSON 2.6 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 3 · Lesson 2 of 2
Unit 2: River Valley Civilizations

Lesson 2.6: China: The Huang He and the Shang Dynasty

Student goal	I can explain how geography shaped early China and describe the achievements of the Shang dynasty.
Objective	Students explain geography's role in early China and Shang achievements.
Standard	C3 D2.Geo.4.6-8, D2.His.1.6-8 — Explain how physical geography shaped civilizations.
Pacing	Unit 2, week 3, lesson 2 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Paper plates, workbook Lesson 2.6
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Friend or enemy river.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson; study the map.
Analyze	10	Discuss natural barriers. Model reading an oracle bone question.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook. The Weekly Check comes next.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Thinking China had contact with Egypt or Sumer.

SUPPORT

- Map labeling of barriers.

EXTEND

- Compare an oracle-bone character with its modern form.

STUDENT LESSON 2.6 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 2.6: China: The Huang He and the Shang Dynasty

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 2.6, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 2.6 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity, Oracle Bone Question, on your Activity Sheet (Workbook Lesson 2.6, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.6, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 2.6: Parts D–E.

THINK ABOUT IT

A river that feeds you and also floods your village every few years: would you call it a friend or an enemy?

Ancient China



China's first civilizations grew along the Huang He.

China's first civilization grew along the Huang He, or Yellow River, named for the yellow loess soil it carries. The soil was rich, but the river flooded so often and so violently that it was called "China's Sorrow." Farmers built dikes and canals to control it. Mountains, deserts, and the sea cut China off from other early civilizations, so its culture developed largely on its own.

The Shang dynasty (about 1600–1046 BCE) is China's first dynasty with written records. Shang kings ruled from cities such as Anyang. Skilled workers cast beautiful bronze vessels for ceremonies, and farmers grew millet and raised silkworms.

Shang kings asked their ancestors and gods for advice with oracle bones. A priest carved a question, such as “Will the harvest be good?” on a turtle shell or ox bone, then touched it with a hot rod until it cracked. The cracks were read as the answer. These carvings are the oldest Chinese writing, and modern Chinese characters grew from them.

ACTIVITY · ORACLE BONE QUESTION

How did the Shang record questions for their ancestors?

You need: a paper plate or a piece of cardboard cut like a shell; a pencil.

1. Write a yes-or-no question a Shang king might ask (harvest, weather, war, or a journey).
2. Draw three pictograph characters to stand for key words.
3. Draw crack lines across the “shell.”
4. On the back, explain why the Shang kept these records.

Record: your oracle bone and explanation.

★ KEY IDEA

The Huang He gave China rich loess soil but deadly floods. The Shang dynasty cast bronze and wrote on oracle bones, the oldest Chinese writing.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Why was the Huang He called “China's Sorrow”?

Answer: It flooded often and violently.

2. What is a dynasty?

Answer: a series of rulers from the same family

3. What were oracle bones used for?

Answer: to ask questions of ancestors and gods; they hold the oldest Chinese writing

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 2.6

#	Question	Answer
1	Fine yellow wind-blown soil	loess
2	Rulers from one family	dynasty

#	Question	Answer
3	Draw your oracle bone and the question carved on it.	Answers vary. Check that every part is filled in and matches what the student did.
4	Explain your question and why a Shang king might ask it.	Answers vary. Check that every part is filled in and matches what the student did.
5	Why was the Huang He called “China's Sorrow”?	It flooded often and violently.
6	What is a dynasty?	a series of rulers from the same family
7	What were oracle bones used for?	to ask questions of ancestors and gods; they hold the oldest Chinese writing
8	What does Huang He mean?	Yellow River
9	Name one natural barrier around China.	e.g. mountains, the Gobi Desert, the sea
10	About when did the Shang rule?	about 1600–1046 BCE
11	What metal did Shang artisans cast?	bronze
12	How did China's geography make its culture develop differently from Egypt's and Mesopotamia's?	Natural barriers cut China off, so its culture developed largely on its own.
13	Was the Huang He more of a friend or an enemy to early China? Defend your answer with two details.	Answers vary; must use details such as rich soil and floods.

WEEKLY CHECK · ANSWER KEY
After Lesson 2.6

About 15 minutes

Weekly Check 3: India's Beliefs and Early China — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Actions decide your future	karma
2	Founder of Buddhism	Siddhartha Gautama (the Buddha)
3	Maurya emperor who spread Buddhism	Ashoka
4	China's first river civilization	the Huang He (Yellow River) valley
5	Shang objects with the oldest Chinese writing	oracle bones
6	Name one way Buddhism was different from Hindu society.	Buddhism welcomed people of every caste.

LESSON 2.7 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 4 · Lesson 1 of 2

Unit 2: River Valley Civilizations

Lesson 2.7: Zhou, Qin, and Han: Confucius, the Great Wall, and the Silk Road

Student goal	I can explain the Mandate of Heaven, Confucius's teachings, and the achievements of the Qin and Han dynasties.
Objective	Students explain Chinese political ideas and dynastic achievements.
Standard	C3 D2.His.2.6-8, D2.Civ.6.6-8 — Explain how ideas shaped government; analyze primary sources.
Pacing	Unit 2, week 4, lesson 1 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Workbook Lesson 2.7
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Should a bad ruler keep ruling?
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson and the Analects excerpt.
Analyze	10	Model the dynastic cycle. Close-read the three sayings.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook lesson pages: Warm-Up through Exit Ticket.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Thinking the Great Wall was built all at once.

SUPPORT

- Dynastic-cycle diagram.

EXTEND

- Research how Han paper was made.

STUDENT LESSON 2.7 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 2.7: Zhou, Qin, and Han: Confucius, the Great Wall, and the Silk Road

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 2.7, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 2.7 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.7, Part B.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 2.7: Parts C–E.

THINK ABOUT IT

Should a ruler who governs badly be allowed to keep ruling? Who should decide?

The Zhou dynasty (1046–256 BCE) overthrew the Shang and explained why with a new idea: the Mandate of Heaven. A good ruler had heaven's blessing; floods, famine, or rebellion showed that a ruler had lost it, and a new dynasty could take power. This pattern of rise and fall is called the dynastic cycle.

Late in the Zhou period, China fell into wars between states. A teacher named Confucius (551–479 BCE) taught that order would return if people behaved well in their relationships: rulers should be fair, children should show filial piety, and everyone should be honest and respectful. Another thinker, Laozi, taught Daoism, living simply and in harmony with nature.

READING · PRIMARY SOURCE

From the Analects of Confucius

Sayings of Confucius (551–479 BCE), recorded by his students. Translated by James Legge (1861). Public domain.

The Master said, “He who exercises government by means of his virtue may be compared to the north polar star, which keeps its place and all the stars turn towards it.” (2.1)

The Master said, “When you know a thing, to hold that you know it; and when you do not know a thing, to allow that you do not know it; this is knowledge.” (2.17)

> The Master said, "What you do not want done to yourself, do not do to others." (15.23)

In 221 BCE, Qin Shi Huang united China and called himself the First Emperor. He ruled harshly but standardized writing, money, weights, and even cart axles. He linked older walls into an early Great Wall to keep out northern invaders and was buried with an army of more than 7,000 life-size clay soldiers, the Terracotta Army.

The Han dynasty (206 BCE–220 CE) ruled for about 400 years. Han emperors chose officials partly by testing their knowledge of Confucian ideas. The Han invented paper and opened the Silk Road, trade routes that carried Chinese silk west and brought horses, glass, and new ideas, including Buddhism, into China.

★ KEY IDEA

The Zhou introduced the Mandate of Heaven; Confucius taught respect, duty, and fair government; the Qin unified and standardized China; the Han invented paper and opened the Silk Road.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. What is the Mandate of Heaven?

Answer: the belief that heaven gives a just ruler the right to rule and can take it away

2. What is filial piety?

Answer: respect and duty toward parents and elders

3. Name one thing Qin Shi Huang standardized.

Answer: e.g. writing, money, weights, cart axles

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 2.7

#	Question	Answer
1	Respect and duty toward parents	filial piety
2	Trade routes linking China with the West	the Silk Road
3	What is the Mandate of Heaven?	the belief that heaven gives a just ruler the right to rule and can take it away
4	What is filial piety?	respect and duty toward parents and elders
5	Name one thing Qin Shi Huang standardized.	e.g. writing, money, weights, cart axles

#	Question	Answer
6	In 2.1, what does Confucius compare a virtuous ruler to?	the north polar star
7	In your own words, what is knowledge according to 2.17?	knowing what you know and admitting what you don't
8	Rewrite 15.23 in your own words. Where have you heard a similar idea?	Don't treat others in ways you wouldn't want to be treated; similar to the Golden Rule.
9	Which dynasty introduced the Mandate of Heaven?	the Zhou
10	Who called himself the First Emperor?	Qin Shi Huang
11	What was buried with the First Emperor?	the Terracotta Army
12	Name one Han invention.	paper
13	Choose Confucius or Qin Shi Huang. How did his ideas or actions bring order to China?	Answers vary; Confucius through good behavior in relationships; Qin through force and standardization.

LESSON 2.8 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 4 · Lesson 2 of 2
Unit 2: River Valley Civilizations

Lesson 2.8: Comparing River Valley Civilizations

Student goal	I can compare the first four civilizations and explain what they had in common.
Objective	Students compare the four river valley civilizations.
Standard	C3 D2.His.1.6-8, D2.Geo.4.6-8 — Compare historical developments in different places.
Pacing	Unit 2, week 4, lesson 2 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Index cards, colored pencils, workbook Lesson 2.8, Unit 2 Review
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Why rivers?
Read and Discuss	15	Review the comparison chart.
Analyze	10	Model a comparison claim.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook; then the Unit 2 Review.
Exit Ticket	3	Next: Unit 2 Test.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Listing facts without comparing.

SUPPORT

- Claim sentence frames.

EXTEND

- Add a fifth early civilization (such as the Olmec or Norte Chico) to the chart.

STUDENT LESSON 2.8 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 2.8: Comparing River Valley Civilizations

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 2.8, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 2.8 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity, Museum Exhibit Card, on your Activity Sheet (Workbook Lesson 2.8, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.8, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 2.8: Parts D–E.

THINK ABOUT IT

Mesopotamia, Egypt, the Indus Valley, and China never planned together. Why did all four grow up beside rivers?

The world's first four civilizations each grew in a river valley: Mesopotamia on the Tigris and Euphrates, Egypt on the Nile, the Indus Valley on the Indus, and China on the Huang He. Rivers gave water, rich soil, and routes for trade. Farming made a food surplus, which let people take on special jobs, build cities, and form governments.

	Mesopotamia	Egypt	Indus Valley	China
river	Tigris and Euphrates	Nile	Indus	Huang He
floods	unpredictable	regular, gentle	monsoon floods	violent
government	city-states, then empires	pharaoh (theocracy)	unknown; organized cities	dynasties; Mandate of Heaven
writing	cuneiform	hieroglyphics	undeciphered script	oracle-bone characters
one legacy	written laws	pyramids	city planning	Confucian ideas

LOOK CLOSER · WRITE A COMPARISON CLAIM

How were Egypt's and China's rivers different, and why did it matter?

1 Contrast: the Nile flooded gently on a regular schedule; the Huang He flooded violently.

2 Effect: Egyptians could plan farming around the flood; Chinese farmers spent great effort on dikes.

3 Claim: both rivers fed people, but the Huang He demanded more control.

Answer: A strong comparison names a similarity or difference and explains why it matters.

ACTIVITY · MUSEUM EXHIBIT CARD

What is each civilization's greatest legacy?

You need: four index cards; colored pencils.

1 Choose one achievement from each civilization.

2 Draw it on the front of a card.

3 On the back, write the civilization, the achievement, and why it still matters today.

4 Rank your four cards from most to least important and explain your top choice.

Record: your four cards and a sentence explaining your top choice.

★ KEY IDEA

All four first civilizations grew in river valleys, made food surpluses, built cities, developed governments, and created writing, but each had its own geography and legacy.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. What did all four river valley civilizations have in common?

Answer: e.g. rivers, farming surplus, cities, government, writing

2. Which civilization's writing has not been deciphered?

Answer: the Indus Valley

3. Whose floods were most regular and predictable?

Answer: Egypt's (the Nile)

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 2.8

#	Question	Answer
1	To find how things are different	contrast
2	Something handed down from the past	legacy
3	Record your results in the table. (figure)	Answers vary. Check that every part is filled in and matches what the student did.
4	Explain your top choice.	Answers vary. Check that every part is filled in and matches what the student did.

#	Question	Answer
5	What did all four river valley civilizations have in common?	e.g. rivers, farming surplus, cities, government, writing
6	Which civilization's writing has not been deciphered?	the Indus Valley
7	Whose floods were most regular and predictable?	Egypt's (the Nile)
8	Writing system of Mesopotamia	cuneiform
9	River of China's first civilization	Huang He
10	Government of Egypt	a pharaoh; a theocracy
11	Civilization known for planned grid cities	the Indus Valley
12	Write a comparison claim about two civilizations. Name a similarity or difference and explain why it matters.	Answers vary; must name two civilizations, a similarity/difference, and its importance.
13	Why do you think civilizations began in river valleys and not in deserts or mountains?	Rivers gave water, rich soil, and transportation, which made a food surplus and cities possible.

UNIT REVIEW · ANSWER KEY
Study before the unit test

About 40 minutes

Unit 2 Review — Answer Key

Homework or a study session before the test.

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	silt	rich soil left by water
2	pharaoh	ruler of Egypt seen as a god
3	cultural diffusion	spread of ideas between groups
4	monsoon	seasonal wind that brings heavy rain
5	dynasty	rulers from one family
6	Mandate of Heaven	heaven's approval to rule
7	Choose two river valley civilizations. Explain how each river shaped the civilization that grew beside it.	Answers vary; accurate river details and effects for both.

UNIT TEST · ANSWER KEY
At the end of the unit

About 45 minutes

Unit 2 Test — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Why is Upper Egypt in the south?	It is upriver; the Nile flows north.
2	Why did Egyptians make mummies?	They believed the dead needed their bodies in the afterlife.
3	Which helped scholars read hieroglyphics? A. the Great Pyramid B. the Rosetta Stone C. oracle bones D. the Code of Hammurabi	B. the Rosetta Stone
4	Name one way Kush and Egypt influenced each other.	e.g. trade; conquest; Kush adopted Egyptian gods, pyramids, and writing
5	Name one feature of Indus Valley cities.	e.g. grid streets, drains, baked bricks, citadel
6	Which is a Buddhist teaching? A. the Mandate of Heaven B. the Four Noble Truths C. ma'at D. filial piety	B. the Four Noble Truths
7	What is reincarnation?	the belief that the soul is reborn in a new body
8	How did Ashoka spread his ideas?	stone pillar edicts and teachers
9	Use the map. Along which labeled river did the Shang dynasty rule? (figure)	the Huang He (Yellow River)
10	What did the Mandate of Heaven explain?	why dynasties rose and fell; a just ruler had heaven's approval
11	Name one Han achievement.	paper or the Silk Road
12	Who taught that rulers should be fair and children should honor parents? A. Qin Shi Huang B. Laozi C. Confucius D. Ashoka	C. Confucius
13	Reread the sayings of Confucius. What do they suggest about how Confucius thought people and rulers should behave? Use two sayings as evidence.	Rubric: clear claim about virtue/respect (1); two sayings cited accurately (1); explanation linking them to behavior or government (1).

#	Question	Answer
14	Compare two river valley civilizations. Explain one similarity and one difference, and why each matters.	Rubric: two civilizations named (1); accurate similarity (1); accurate difference (1); explains why it matters (1).

Scoring

Score	What it means / next step
17–19 (85%+)	Mastered.
14–16	Proficient; review missed skills.
Below 14	Reteach and retest.

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Teacher Edition

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INSIDE THIS YEAR

01 Early Humans and Mesopotamia

02 River Valley Civilizations

IN THIS BOOK

- Week-by-week pacing guide
- Guided lessons with timing and teaching moves
- Misconceptions, supports, and extensions
- Answer keys and scoring guides for every page

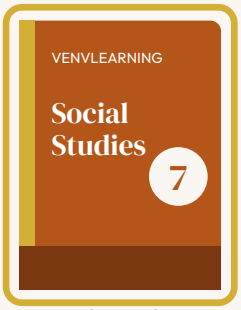
THE COMPLETE SET



Textbook



Workbook



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